



Calibration: Defining Proficiency Together

Building a shared picture of proficiency — before student work exists.

Why this meeting matters

Teams often think they agree on a standard until they try to describe exactly what proficient work looks like. This meeting builds that shared picture before any assessment is written — so the common assessment is designed around one agreed definition of proficiency, not five.

You can't truly calibrate scoring until students have produced work, so that comes later — after the first common assessment. What you can do now: each teacher writes a proficient and a not-yet anchor for a key target, the team compares them, surfaces the disagreements, and refines the success criteria. The disagreements are the point.

Meeting 8 · Wednesday, November 18, 2026 · 45 minutes

Focus	Are we truly clear on what students must learn and what proficiency looks like?
Leave with	Agreed proficiency anchors and refined success criteria for each learning target.

Agenda — step by step

Time	What the team does
0–5 min	Review norms and roles. Confirm who holds each role today and re-read your norms. Revisit your essential standard, learning targets, and success criteria.
5–20 min	Write anchors. Each teacher writes what a proficient response to one key learning target looks like — and a not-yet-proficient one. Writing the “proficient” answer forces you to commit to what proficiency actually is.
20–33 min	Compare and find the line. Put the anchors side by side. Where do you disagree about whether a response is “there yet”? Those disagreements are the work — name them honestly.
33–42 min	Refine success criteria. Adjust your success criteria so they capture what the team agreed proficiency means, in specific, observable language.
42–45 min	Preview the real calibration. True scoring calibration comes after students take the common assessment — this shared picture is what you'll calibrate against then.

Where we're going next → Meeting 9: Designing the Common Formative Assessment. You'll build the assessment around the proficiency you just defined (PLC Question 2: How will we know they've learned it?).